

Additional combinations and sign:

*lam- <i>'alif</i>	ﻻ	lā
tā marbūṭa	ﺎ	-at-
hamza	ء	'
šadda	ّ	[doubling]
<i>'alif</i> -madda	آ	'ā

The only two letter combination to have separate form in the alphabet is
Combination lām + *'alif*

Numerals:

Compound numerals are written like English, from left to right (365 = ٣٦٥)

1 ١ 2 ٢ 3 ٣ 4 ٤ 5 ٥ 6 ٦ 7 ٧ 8 ٨ 9 ٩ 10 ١٠

The Vowel Signs.

6.1 The short vowels and the sign of quiescence:

(1) *fatḥa*, the sign for *a*, is a short diagonal stroke placed over the consonant it follows in pronunciation, as in كَتَبَ *kataba* and خَرَجَ *xaraja*.

(2) *kasra*, the sign for *i*, is the same diagonal stroke placed under the consonant it follows in pronunciation, as in مِنَ *mina* and بِهِ *bihi*.

(3) *ḍamma*, the sign for *u*, is a small *wāw* placed over the consonant it follows in pronunciation, as in كُتُبُ *kutubu* and رَجُلُ *rajulu*.

(4) In fully vocalized texts such as the Koran, every consonant must be marked, hence the existence of sukūn, the sign for no vowel at all (quiescence), usually written as a small circle above the consonant, as in كَتَبْتُ *katabtu* and مِنْ *min*.

The **long vowel** signs are as follows:

(1) *ā* is indicated by *fatḥa* plus *alif*, as in كَاتِبًا *kātibā* and قَامَ *qāma*. Note that *ā* is often, especially in the Koran, written defectively as “dagger alif” above the consonant, as in اللَّهُ *allāhu* and إِبْرَاهِيمُ *’ibrāhīmu*.

(2) *ī* is indicated by *kasra* plus *yā’*, as in كَبِيرَ *kabīr-* and دِينَ *dīn-*.

(3) *ū* is indicated by *ḍamma* plus *wāw*, as in رَسُولَ *rasūl-* and ثُومَ *thūm-*.

6.3 The diphthong signs are a combination of the short vowel *a* and consonant.

(1) *ay* is indicated by *fatḥa* plus *yā’*, as in أَيْنَ *’ayna*

(2) *aw* is indicated by *fatḥa* plus *wāw*, as in دَوْرَ *dawr-*

Otiöse alif, in certain conjugation forms an *alif* is appended to a lengthening *wāw*, as in كَتَبُوا *katabū*. This *alif* is not pronounced and serves merely to indicate the verbal form. It owes its existence to early orthographic conventions.

Alif maqṣūra, the *alif maqṣūra*, also called *alif bi-ṣūratī l-yā’* (*Alif masquerading as yā*), occurs word-finally only. Written like a *yā’*, it is pronounced exactly like a lengthening *alif*, as in الْمَعْنَى *al-ma’nā* and رَمَى *ramā*. When any enclitic suffix is added to *alif bi-ṣūratī l-yā’* it becomes “tall” *alif*, as in مَعْنَاهُ *ma’nā-hu* and رَمَاهُ *ramā-hu*.

Additional Orthographic signs:

Hamza, the sign of the glottal stop (’). Word-initially it is invariably written on *alif*. When the vowel of the *hamza* is *a* or *u*, the *hamza* is commonly written above the *alif*, as in أَرْضَ *’ard-* and أَنْ *’an*.

But when the vowel is *i*, the *hamza* is commonly written beneath the *alif*, as in إِنْسَانَ *’insān-* and إِنْ *’in*.

Non-initially the “bearer” of the hamza may be:

- (1) alif, as in سال sa’ala [to flow or to drip/run]
- (2) wāw, as in سؤال su’āl- [question, inquiry/query, request]
- (3) yā without dots, as in رأس ra’īs- [head]
- (4) nothing, as in نساء nisā’- [women]

Waṣla, a small initial ṣād, is the sign of elision. Many initial vowels, notably the vowel of the definite article, are elided when not in sentence-initial position. When such elision occurs, the Waṣla is placed over the alif. E.g., when sentence initial, الأرض ‘al-’arḍu but في الأرض fi l-’arḍi.

Šadda, the sign of gemination. Doubled consonants are never written twice in Arabic but are indicated by placing the sign šadda over the doubled consonant. In unvocalized texts the šadda may be indicated sporadically, but it is not normally given.

Jannat- جنة	makkat- مكة
-sayyid سيد	nabīy- (nabiyya-) نبي
radda د ر	nubūwat-(nubuwwat) نبوة

Alif-madda, the sign of glottal stop (‘) followed by ā. Word initially ‘ā is written with alif-madda in order to avoid the conjunction of two alifs, a situation that is not ordinarily permitted orthographically.

‘āmana آمن al-’āyat- الآية

Tā’ marbūṭa occurs word-finally only. It is written like a ha’ with two dots above. Invariably preceded by the vowel a (long or short), it is pronounced exactly like a t except in causal form.

hayāti حياة	madīnatu مدينة
but madīnatunā مدينتنا	hayātihim حياتهم